

Nurturing potential.

A flexible 60 / 90 / 120-minute route for Irish post-primary staff.

Core communication job

Disadvantage changes the obstacles around learning, not the ceiling on a child's potential. Consistent adult and whole-school practices can change the odds.



Choose the route; keep the spine.

01

60 minutes

Keep slides 1-5, 7, 9-12, 14-15, 17, 19-21, 23-25. Use the worked case rather than group case time.

02

90 minutes

Use the full core deck. Allow 12 minutes for the case and 15 minutes for the 90-day plan.

03

120 minutes

Use the full deck. Extend expectation audit, case work and peer critique of school plans.

SAFEGUARDING BOUNDARY

Do not invite public disclosure of trauma, poverty, family circumstances or named student cases. If a participant raises an immediate safeguarding concern, pause the activity and follow the school's established procedures.

Keep the door open.

NURTURING POTENTIAL

Keep the door open.

Helping every young person succeed in second-level education and navigate a future beyond it.

An Irish post-primary workshop for teachers, year heads and school leaders



PURPOSE

Set a hopeful, demanding frame: this is about changing conditions, not rescuing or labelling children.

SAY

Welcome the room. Name the destination: stronger expectations, better learning support, and a small whole-school plan people can actually carry back.

ASK / DO

None yet. Let the first minute feel intentional.

WATCH FOR

Avoid framing staff as the problem or students as damaged.

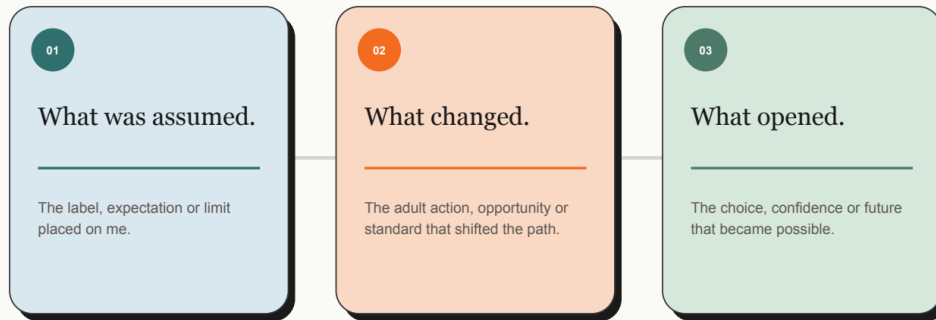
ROUTE

Core in every version.

Before the data, a person.

START HERE

Before the data, a person.



Tell the story in three beats. Your lived experience leads; the evidence follows.

02

PURPOSE

Give the evidence a human anchor and establish the presenter's credibility without turning the story into a universal template.

SAY

Tell your own DEIS journey in three beats: what was assumed about you; the adult, practice or opportunity that altered your trajectory; what still depended on your own agency. End on what became possible.

ASK / DO

You can step into the audience here. Ask listeners to hold one student in mind, without naming them.

WATCH FOR

Do not imply that grit alone overcame structural barriers. Name both support and agency.

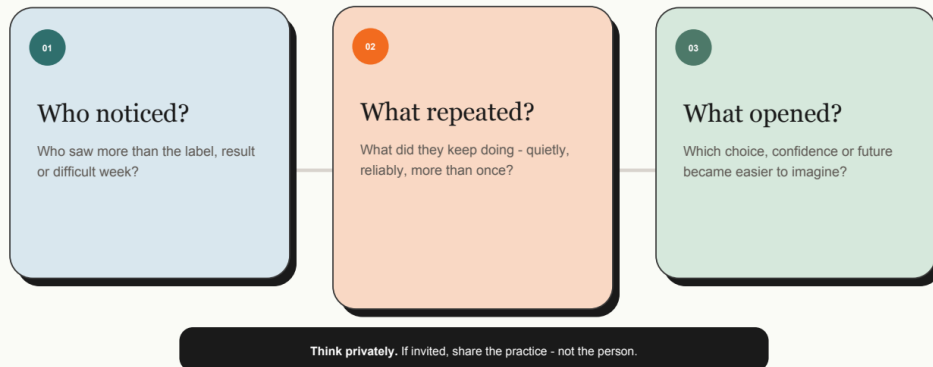
ROUTE

60 min: 5 minutes. 90/120 min: allow 7-8 minutes.

Who changed your odds?

A QUIET QUESTION

Who changed your odds?



No one is required to disclose a personal experience.

03

PURPOSE

Prime the room to notice repeatable adult behaviours rather than heroic one-off gestures.

SAY

Give 30 seconds of silence. Invite two or three responses. Translate each answer into a routine: “checked in” becomes “noticed absence quickly”; “believed in me” becomes “kept the level of challenge high and made the next step visible.”

ASK / DO

“What did they do repeatedly?”

WATCH FOR

Do not force personal disclosure. People may have no positive school adult to name.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120. In 60, take one response only.

One in seven.

THE IRISH STARTING LINE

One in seven.

13.8%

of children lived in households experiencing child-specific enforced deprivation in 2024.

This measure means a household could not afford at least three of 17 child-specific essentials or activities.

It is a description of conditions around childhood
- not a description of a child's capacity.

Source: CSO, SILC Module on Child Deprivation 2024.

04

PURPOSE

Make material disadvantage concrete while separating circumstances from ability.

SAY

Define the statistic before interpreting it. Examples in the measure include adequate clothing, leisure, celebrations and school-related participation. Then state the central distinction: conditions can constrain learning opportunities; they do not measure intelligence or potential.

ASK / DO

"Where might these conditions quietly show up in school routines or expectations?" Take two answers.

WATCH FOR

Do not invite staff to identify "which children" in the room or school.

ROUTE

Core in every version.

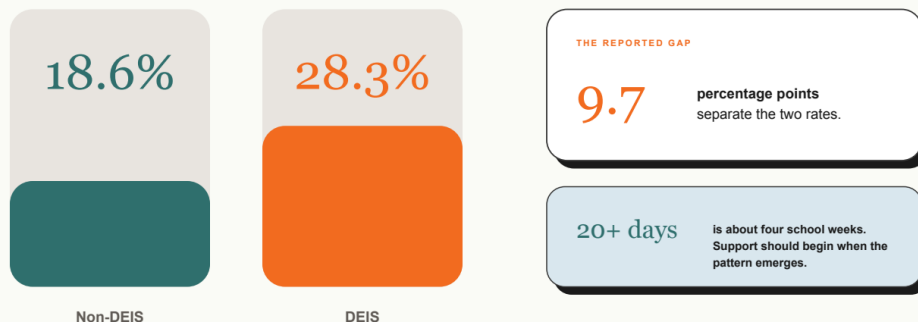
SOURCES

<https://www.cso.ie/en/releasesandpublications/ep/p-silccd/silcmoduleonchilddeprivation2024/keyfindings/>

Absence compounds quietly.

WHERE INEQUALITY ACCUMULATES

Absence compounds quietly.



Source: Tusla Analysis of School Attendance Data 2023/24. Post-primary response coverage: 541 of 722 schools.

05

PURPOSE

Show the size of the attendance gap without treating absence as a character flaw.

SAY

Explain that 28.3% of students in responding DEIS post-primary schools and 18.6% in non-DEIS schools missed 20 or more days. The report covered 541 of 722 post-primary schools, so avoid presenting it as a census of every student.

ASK / DO

“What do we currently notice at day 3, day 5 or day 10 - before a statutory threshold?”

WATCH FOR

Avoid saying absence automatically causes every later outcome. Frame it as lost access to teaching and a signal to investigate barriers.

ROUTE

Core. In 60, move straight to the next slide after the question.

SOURCES

https://www.tusla.ie/uploads/content/Analysis_of_School_Attendance_Data_2023-24.pdf

Progress is real. The remaining gap is real.

A SYSTEM CAN MOVE

Progress is real. The remaining gap is real.



The DEIS/non-DEIS retention gap narrowed from **16.8** to **8.7** percentage points.

Source: Department of Education; Leaving Certificate retention for the 2017 first-year entry cohort.

06

PURPOSE

Prevent fatalism: policy, resourcing and school practice have already shifted retention.

SAY

DEIS retention improved from 68.2% in 2006 to 83.4% for the 2017 entry cohort. The gap narrowed, yet 83.4% still sat below 92.1% in non-DEIS schools. Use both truths together: improvement is possible and unfinished.

ASK / DO

“Which improvement in your own school proves that trajectories can change?”

WATCH FOR

Be precise that these are retention-to-Leaving-Certificate rates, not third-level progression rates.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120; optional in 60.

SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/press-releases/minister-mcentee-launches-national-campaign-on-school-attendance/>
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/>

Background shifts the odds. It does not write the outcome.

THE SAME DATASET HOLDS TWO TRUTHS

Background shifts the odds. It does not write the outcome.



Source: OECD PISA 2022 Ireland country note. Interpret with the OECD's response-rate caveat for Ireland.

07

PURPOSE

Hold inequality and agency together, avoiding both blame and determinism.

SAY

The 74-point gap signals unequal odds. The 12% resilience figure shows that disadvantage is not destiny. Neither number licenses a prediction about an individual student. Note that OECD flagged Ireland's response rate and estimated mean scores may be somewhat high; the slide uses the within-country gap and resilience rate cautiously.

ASK / DO

"What changes when we treat data as a prompt for support rather than a forecast of a child?"

WATCH FOR

Do not call resilient students "exceptions" in a way that blames peers who face different barriers.

ROUTE

Core in every version.

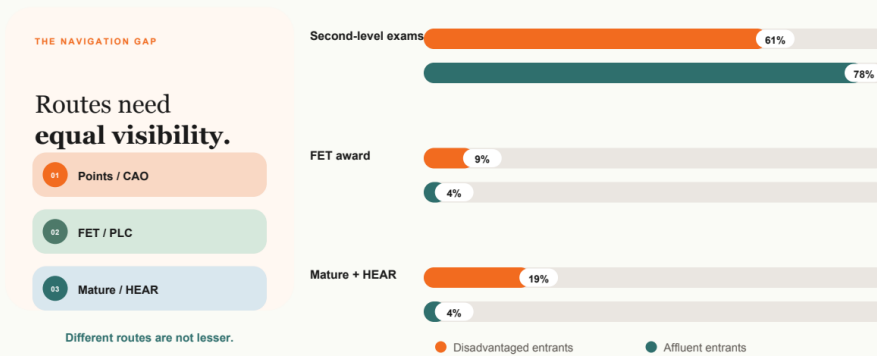
SOURCES

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/pisa-2022-results-volume-i-and-ii-country-notes_ed6fbcc5-en/ireland_01173012-en.html

The route into higher education is uneven.

OPPORTUNITY INCLUDES NAVIGATION

The route into higher education is uneven.



Source: HEA socioeconomic student profile, undergraduate entrants 2021/22-2023/24. Categories shown do not exhaust all entry routes.

08

PURPOSE

Show that progression depends partly on navigation and access routes, not only points.

SAY

Among undergraduate entrants in the HEA profile, 61% of disadvantaged entrants came via second-level exams compared with 78% of affluent entrants; FET and mature/HEAR routes were more prominent for disadvantaged entrants. The categories on screen are selected routes and do not sum to 100%.

ASK / DO

“Are we giving parallel routes equal time, status and practical support?”

WATCH FOR

Do not imply every disadvantaged learner should pursue higher education. The purpose is informed choice across routes.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120; optional data detail in 60.

SOURCES

<https://hea.ie/statistics/data-for-download-and-visualisations/students/widening-participation-for-equity-of-access/socio-economic-profiles-2021-22-2023-24/student-profile/>

Data can sharpen action - or harden a stereotype.

THE DANGER IN THE STORY WE TELL

Data can sharpen action - or harden a stereotype.

THE QUICK CONCLUSION

*"They do not value school."**"The family will not engage."**"Not college material."**"Trauma explains the behaviour."*

THE USEFUL QUESTION

"What makes attendance harder here?"**"How accessible and trustworthy is our contact?"****"Which routes and supports are still invisible?"****"What supports regulation and a return to learning?"**

Principle: ask about barriers without lowering expectations or removing accountability.

09

PURPOSE

Challenge deficit thinking while keeping professional accountability and behavioural boundaries intact.

SAY

Read one or two pairs aloud. Emphasise that a barrier question is not an excuse; it is a better route to an effective response. Expectations remain high, while support becomes more accurate.

ASK / DO

Invite pairs to rewrite one phrase they hear in their own context. Do not collect identifiable examples.

WATCH FOR

Keep the tone challenging but non-shaming. Staff need enough psychological safety to examine practice honestly.

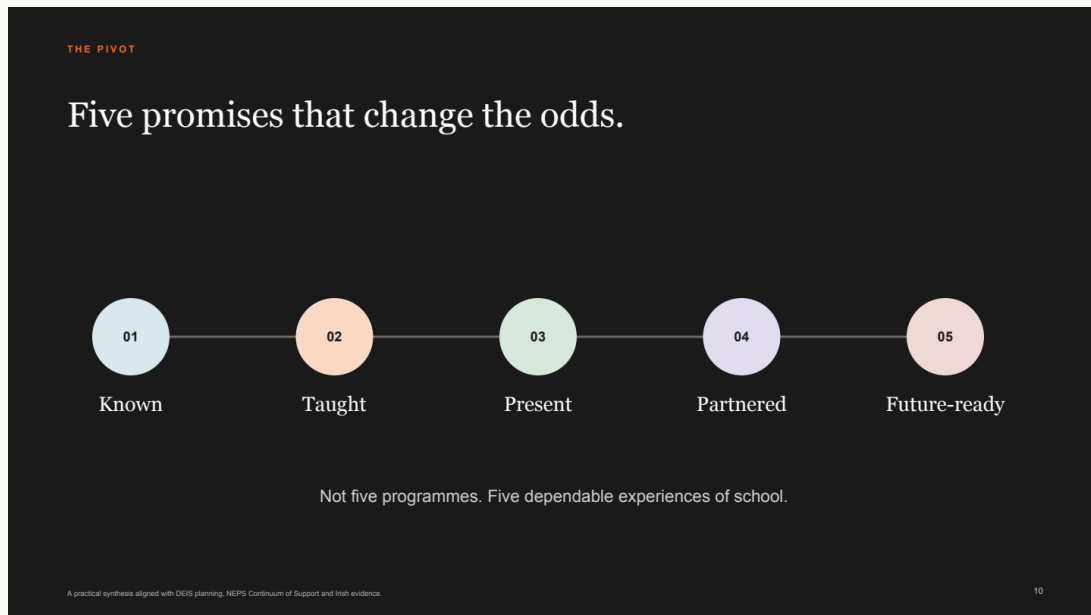
ROUTE

Core. In 120, allow 5 minutes in pairs; in 60, model one rewrite.

SOURCES

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

Five promises that change the odds.



PURPOSE

Give the workshop a memorable whole-school architecture.

SAY

Introduce the five promises: every student is known; taught ambitiously; supported to attend; partnered with through family and community; and future-ready with navigable pathways. They are experiences to make dependable, not five new initiatives.

ASK / DO

Ask people to note which promise is currently strongest and which is least dependable.

WATCH FOR

Do not let the language imply a guarantee of outcomes. The guarantee is the quality and consistency of provision.

ROUTE

Core in every version.

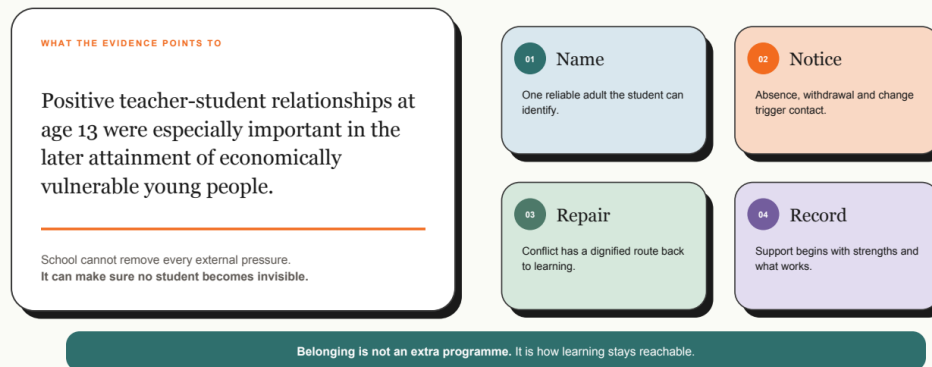
SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/>
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/services/national-educational-psychological-service-neps/>
https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

Relationships are learning infrastructure.

PROMISE 01 · KNOWN

Relationships are learning infrastructure.



Source: ESRI / Growing Up in Ireland research on self-concept, expectations and teacher-student relationships.

11

PURPOSE

Move relationships out of the “nice extra” category and into the school's learning design.

SAY

Summarise the ESRI finding carefully as longitudinal association/model evidence, not proof that one relationship alone determines attainment. Then make the practice concrete: named adult, fast noticing, repair, and strength-based information.

ASK / DO

Private prompt: “Can the student you held in mind name their adult?”

WATCH FOR

A named adult must have a routine and capacity; a spreadsheet assignment alone is not a relationship.

ROUTE

Core. In 120, invite examples of effective repair after conflict.

SOURCES

<https://www.esri.ie/publications/how-are-childrens-academic-self-concepts-their-parents-expectations-and-their>
<https://www.esri.ie/publications/we-respect-them-and-they-respect-us-the-value-of-interpersonal-relationships-in>

High expectations need high support.

PROMISE 02 · TAUGHT

High expectations need high support.



The goal is not “be tougher.”
The goal is to make ambitious work **legible, scaffolded and attainable.**

Workshop framework: distinguish demand from access, and care from lowered ceilings.

12

PURPOSE

Replace the false choice between compassion and academic ambition.

SAY

Walk through the four quadrants. “Ambitious access” means preserving the intellectual goal while making the route visible: worked examples, vocabulary, guided practice, feedback, time and re-entry after absence. High expectation without access becomes sink-or-swim; support without challenge becomes a kind ceiling.

ASK / DO

“Where can a well-intended support accidentally reduce future options - subject level, task demand, timetable, or pathway advice?”

WATCH FOR

Do not criticise individual accommodations. The issue is whether support preserves access to meaningful learning and choice.

ROUTE

Core. In 120, let departments map one current practice onto the matrix.

SOURCES

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

Teach the route, not only the destination.

MAKE SUCCESS VISIBLE

Teach the route, not only the destination.



Metacognition works best inside subject teaching: model how an expert plans, monitors and evaluates a real task.

Sources: Education Endowment Foundation guidance on metacognition/self-regulation and feedback.

13

PURPOSE

Translate high support into classroom moves with a strong evidence base.

SAY

Keep this subject-specific. Model how to plan an essay, decode a source, set out a calculation or test an answer. Use checks that sample the whole class. Feedback should create a next action, and scaffolds should fade toward independence.

ASK / DO

"Which step is most likely to remain hidden for students who have less academic help outside school?"

WATCH FOR

Avoid presenting the sequence as a rigid lesson script. It is a planning lens.

ROUTE

90/120 core. In 60, combine verbally with the expectations matrix.

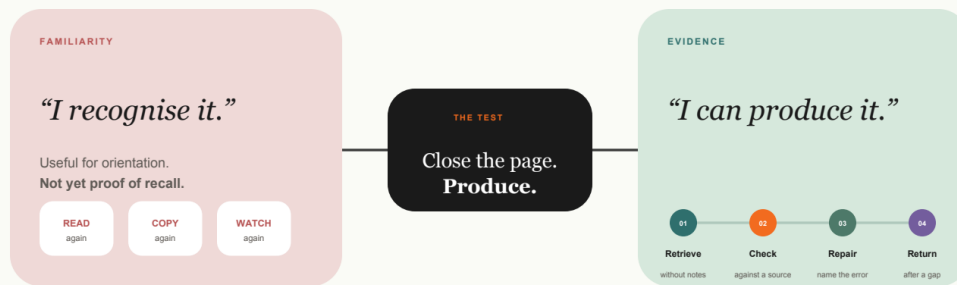
SOURCES

<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/guidance-reports/feedback>

Studying is not the same as learning.

STUDY CORRECTLY · 01

Studying is not the same as learning.



Input can orient. Evidence shows what survived when the page disappeared.

Evidence base: IES practice guide on retrieval, spacing and worked examples; EEF metacognition guidance.

14

PURPOSE

Give staff and students a usable distinction between study activity and evidence of learning.

SAY

Rereading, copying and watching may support orientation, but they do not by themselves test whether knowledge can be produced later. Teach a repeatable cycle: retrieve without notes, check accurately, repair the error, and revisit after a gap.

ASK / DO

"Which study behaviours do we praise because they look diligent, even when they produce little evidence of learning?"

WATCH FOR

Do not tell students that all rereading or note-making is useless. The distinction is between input and proof of recall or application.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120. In 60, use the contrast and the closing sentence.

SOURCES

<https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1>

<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>

A study session needs an ending, not just a timer.

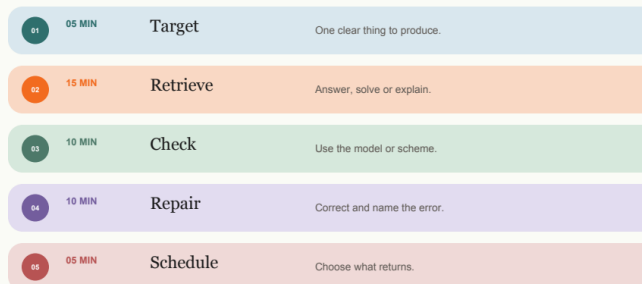
STUDY CORRECTLY · 02

A study session needs an ending, not just a timer.

ONE PRACTICAL SHAPE

45
MINUTES

The time can flex.
The sequence cannot.



Target → retrieve → check → repair → return.

Practical template informed by IES retrievalspacing guidance and Irish Department of Education study-routine guidance.

15

PURPOSE

Turn “study more” into a teachable, observable routine.

SAY

Present the timings as a flexible 45-minute template, not a validated dose. The important architecture is that every session starts with a target and ends with corrected evidence plus a scheduled revisit. A timer supports attention; it does not prove learning.

ASK / DO

Ask departments to replace the generic instruction “revise this topic” with a target, retrieval task, checking source and revisit date.

WATCH FOR

Adapt duration and breaks for age, need and context. Preserve the learning cycle even when the block is shorter.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120; optional detail in 60.

SOURCES

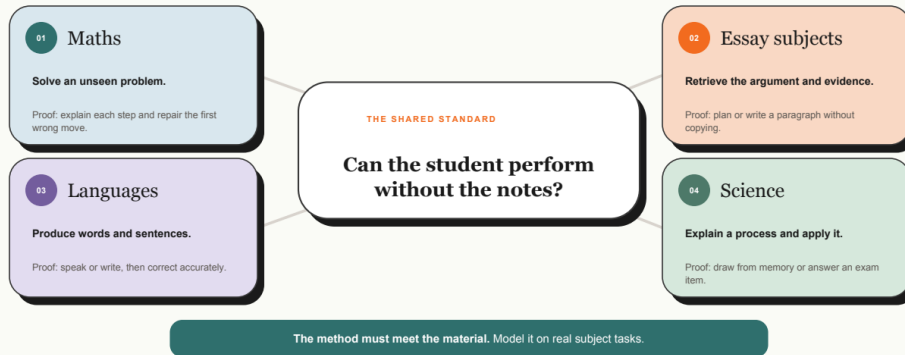
<https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1>

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/how-to-create-study-routines-for-the-leaving-certificate-during-the-covid-19-pandemic/>

Good study changes with the subject.

STUDY CORRECTLY · 03

Good study changes with the subject.



Practice synthesis: retrieval, worked examples, feedback and metacognitive modelling should remain subject-specific.

16

PURPOSE

Prevent generic study-skills advice from becoming detached from the actual demands of subjects.

SAY

Students need teachers to demonstrate what retrieval, checking and repair look like in their discipline. Use real tasks, real criteria and real examples. The same cycle applies across subjects, but the evidence of learning differs.

ASK / DO

Invite each department to write one “proof of learning” task students can do without notes.

WATCH FOR

Avoid turning study skills into another standalone booklet students must decode alone.

ROUTE

90/120 core; optional in 60.

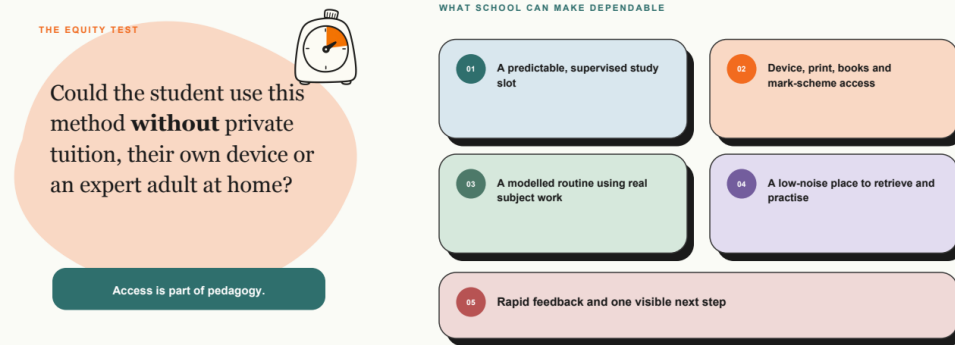
SOURCES

<https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/guidance-reports/feedback>

Do not make success depend on a quiet bedroom.

STUDY CORRECTLY · 04

Do not make success depend on a quiet bedroom.



Equity principle: teach and resource the routine in school; do not assume ideal study conditions at home.

17

PURPOSE

Connect effective study practice to equitable access and whole-school provision.

SAY

Students cannot consistently use a method they have never seen modelled, cannot resource or cannot find a place to practise. Schools cannot remove every home constraint, but they can reduce how much successful study depends on resources and expert help outside school.

ASK / DO

“Which part of our current study advice silently assumes money, space, technology or an academically confident adult at home?”

WATCH FOR

Do not stereotype home environments. Audit the demands created by school routines rather than guessing about individual families.

ROUTE

Core in every version.

SOURCES

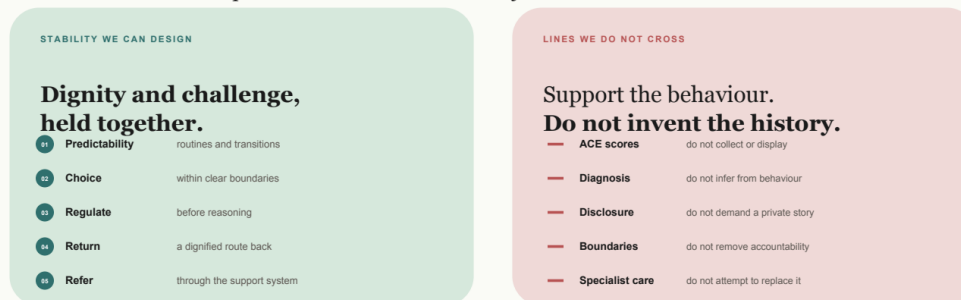
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/how-to-create-study-routines-for-the-leaving-certificate-during-the-covid-19-pandemic/>
https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

Care without lowering the ceiling.

TRAUMA-AWARE, ROLE-CLEAR

Care without lowering the ceiling.

Respond to what is observable. Refer what is not ours to assess.



Notice → support → refer. Keep the student's privacy, dignity and future options intact.

Sources: NEPS trauma resources and Continuum of Support; systematic review evidence; UK government caution on ACE screening.

18

PURPOSE

Give staff a safe, evidence-calibrated role in trauma-sensitive schooling.

SAY

Say directly: teachers should be trauma-aware, not trauma-detectives. NEPS focuses on stress, resilience and a continuum of universal, targeted and individual support. School-wide trauma-informed evidence remains emergent and variable; use sensible practices without making inflated claims. ACE questionnaires are population research tools and should not substitute for comprehensive assessment or gate access to support.

ASK / DO

“Which routine can increase predictability tomorrow without asking any student to disclose?”

WATCH FOR

Remind staff to follow safeguarding procedures for disclosures and immediate risks; do not investigate in the room.

ROUTE

Core in every version. In 120, give 3 minutes to identify one predictable routine and one referral boundary.

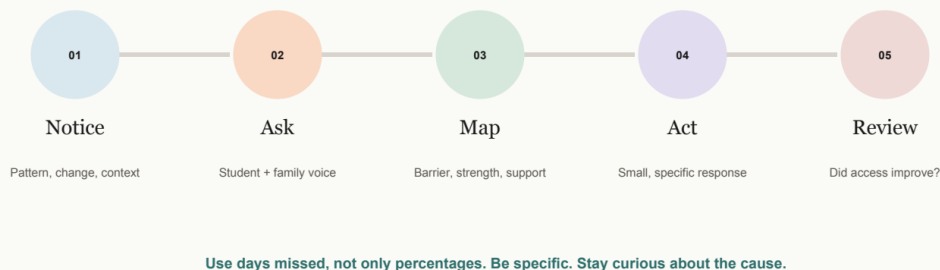
SOURCES

<https://www.gov.uk/en/department-of-education/collections/national-educational-psychological-service-neps-resources-and-publications/>
<https://www.gov.uk/en/department-of-education/services/national-educational-psychological-service-neps/>
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8356508/>
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/trauma-informed-practice-learning-from-experience/trauma-informed-practice-learning-from-experience-of-violence-reduction-unit-delivery-2021-to-2023-accessible>

20 days is a reporting threshold. Support starts sooner.

PROMISE 03 • PRESENT

20 days is a reporting threshold. Support starts sooner.



Sources: Tusla absenteeism guidance and Educational Welfare Services; EEF attendance evidence review.

19

PURPOSE

Shift attendance from late-stage compliance to early, barrier-responsive support.

SAY

Clarify the distinction: Irish schools report students absent 20 days or more, but Tusla also stresses early response. Start with a pattern, seek the student and family perspective, identify the barrier, agree a small response, and review. Escalate through the school's support structures and TESS when in-school efforts are insufficient.

ASK / DO

"At what point does a human conversation happen in our current process?"

WATCH FOR

Exclude bereavement, long-term illness and known sensitive circumstances from automated or shaming messages.

ROUTE

Core. In 120, teams map their current attendance response against the five steps.

SOURCES

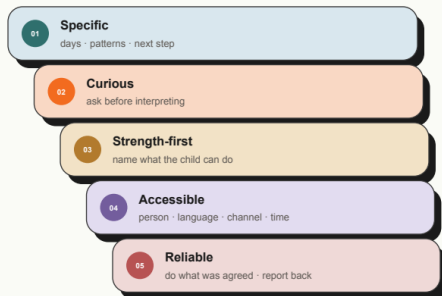
<https://www.tusla.ie/tess/tess-ews/reporting-absenteeism/>
<https://www.tusla.ie/services/educational-welfare-services/ews/>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/leadership-and-planning/supporting-attendance/summary-of-evidence>

Partnership is designed before it is declared.

PROMISE 04 · PARTNERED

Partnership is designed before it is declared.

FIVE HABITS THAT MAKE CONTACT REACHABLE



A STRONGER FIRST CONTACT

*"We have missed Sam on seven mornings.
Sam's oral answers in Science are strong.
Is transport, sleep, caring, anxiety - or
something else - making mornings
harder?"*

"Can we agree one step and check in on Friday?"

Practice synthesis informed by attendance evidence, HSCLIDEIS principles and responsive family engagement.

20

PURPOSE

Make family engagement concrete and reduce deficit assumptions about non-response.

SAY

Contrast generic warnings with specific, strength-based, curious contact. Make the next step small and mutual. Accessibility includes channel, timing, literacy, language, previous school experiences and whether the family can reach a real person.

ASK / DO

Invite participants to rewrite one common message using the five habits.

WATCH FOR

Do not promise confidentiality beyond safeguarding duties or supports the school cannot deliver.

ROUTE

90/120 core. In 60, show the example and move on.

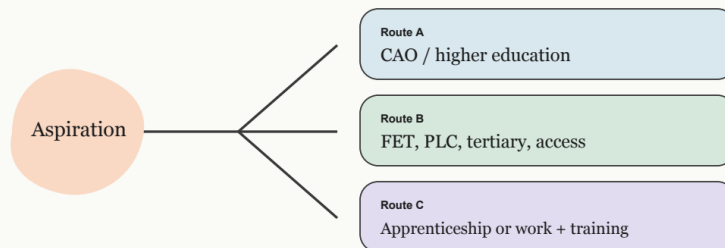
SOURCES

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/leadership-and-planning/supporting-attendance/summary-of-evidence>

A pathway is only real when a student can navigate it.

PROMISE 05 · FUTURE-READY

A pathway is only real when a student can navigate it.



Each route needs · entry requirements · deadlines · cost/funding · a named adult · family understanding · a next action

Sources: DFHERIS pathways overview; HEAR; SUSI; Government of Ireland apprenticeship information.

21

PURPOSE

Give every route status and convert aspiration into practical navigation.

SAY

The CAO points route is one route among many. FET/PLC, tertiary programmes, access/foundation routes, apprenticeships and work-plus-training can lead to meaningful qualifications and careers. Apprenticeships span more than 80 types and NFQ Levels 5-10; at least half the learning is on the job. HEAR, DARE where relevant, and SUSI require early, accurate support and deadlines.

ASK / DO

“Does every fifth-year student have a plausible A, B and C - and know the next action on each?”

WATCH FOR

Do not create a hierarchy where Route B or C is quietly presented as a fallback for “weaker” students.

ROUTE

Core. In 120, participants map routes for the student they held in mind.

SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-further-and-higher-education-research-innovation-and-science/press-releases/ministers-lawless-and-harkin-urge-all-learners-to-explore-the-unprecedented-number-of-education-pathways-now-available/>
<https://accesscollege.ie/hear/how-do-i-apply/eligibility-criteria/>
<https://www.susi.ie/eligibility-reckoner-app-irish/index.html>
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-further-and-higher-education-research-innovation-and-science/services/become-an-apprentice/>

Leah is capable. School is becoming harder to reach.

CASE LAB · COMPOSITE SCENARIO

Leah is capable. School is becoming harder to reach.

LEAH · FIFTH YEAR

Strong oral contributions. Written work is inconsistent. Sixteen days absent by February and often late. She helps care for younger siblings. She says she wants physiotherapy, then adds: “Courses like that are for people with money.”

IN GROUPS

01

What might the school wrongly infer?

02

What do we need to learn from Leah and home?

03

What changes tomorrow, this term and this year?

04

Who owns each next step?

Fictional composite for discussion. Do not diagnose, and do not share identifiable student cases.

22

PURPOSE

Let participants apply the five promises to a complex, non-diagnostic scenario.

SAY

State clearly that Leah is a fictional composite. Groups should separate what is known from what is assumed; identify questions for Leah and family; plan immediate, term and progression actions; and name ownership. Ask them to preserve both dignity and academic ambition.

ASK / DO

Use the four on-screen prompts. Ask for one action per promise, not a long list.

WATCH FOR

Do not let the group diagnose anxiety, trauma, neglect or a learning difficulty. Caring responsibility is context, not a complete explanation.

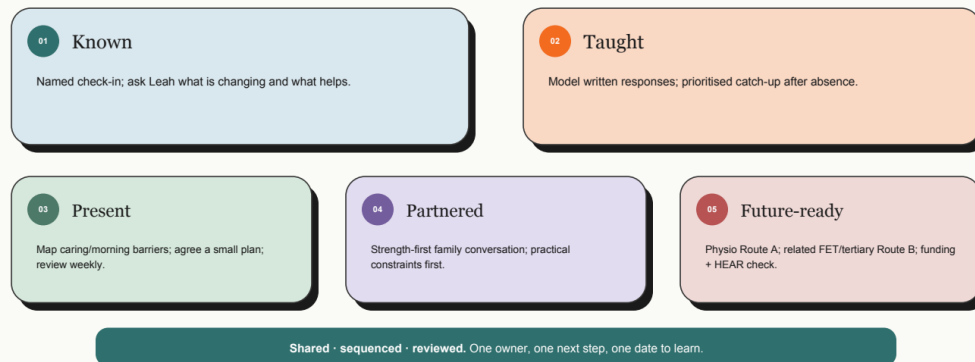
ROUTE

90 min: 8 minutes work + 4 debrief. 120: 15 + 8. 60: omit and use the next slide as a worked example.

Coordinate the supports around the student.

ONE PLAUSIBLE RESPONSE - NOT A PRESCRIPTION

Coordinate the supports around the student.



23

PURPOSE

Model a coherent response and show that no single role should carry the whole case.

SAY

Present this as one plausible response after listening, not a checklist to impose. The key is sequence and ownership: immediate relationship and learning access; barrier-responsive attendance; family partnership; longer-term route planning; and review through the student support structure.

ASK / DO

"What would Leah experience differently by next Monday?"

WATCH FOR

Avoid over-promising access to a specific course or support before checking eligibility and current requirements.

ROUTE

Core after case. In 60, use this slide to explain the case in 3 minutes.

SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/resources-for-student-support-teams/>
<https://accesscollege.ie/hear/how-do-i-apply/eligibility-criteria/>
<https://www.susi.ie/eligibility-reckoner-app-irish/index.html>

How dependable are the five promises?

WHOLE-SCHOOL REALITY CHECK

How dependable are the five promises?

01	02	03	04	05
Known	Taught	Present	Partnered	Future-ready
Can every student name an adult who will notice?	Does support preserve challenge and future options?	Are patterns acted on before 20 days?	Can families reach a person, not only a portal?	Does every student have A, B and C routes?
1 - rarely	1 - rarely	1 - rarely	1 - rarely	1 - rarely
4 - dependable	4 - dependable	4 - dependable	4 - dependable	4 - dependable

Rate the system. Then listen for where students and families would score it differently.

A low score is a planning signal, not a verdict. Do not rank individual staff or students.

24

PURPOSE

Turn broad values into an honest baseline for whole-school planning.

SAY

Participants rate each promise from 1 (person-dependent or inconsistent) to 4 (systematic, visible and reviewed). Ask them to rate the student experience, not the existence of a policy. Their lowest score is not automatically the priority; they should consider urgency, reach and feasibility.

ASK / DO

Silent rating first, then compare at tables. Ask: "Where would students and families rate us differently?"

WATCH FOR

Avoid public ranking of departments or individual staff.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120. In 60, complete silently and select one promise.

SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/>
https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

One 90-day test beats a 30-page aspiration.

FROM INTENTION TO IMPLEMENTATION

One 90-day test beats a 30-page aspiration.

PROMISE	Which student experience will become more dependable?
FOCUS	For whom, where and when is the gap most visible?
ROUTINE	What will adults do differently and how often?
OWNER	Who coordinates, supports and follows through?
EARLY SIGNAL	What should move before outcomes move?
REVIEW	What date will the team learn and adapt?

Small enough to implement. Important enough to matter. Specific enough to learn from.

Planning structure aligned with implementation guidance and DEIS whole-school planning.

25

PURPOSE

Produce a concrete whole-school output before participants leave.

SAY

Teams select one promise and define a focused 90-day test: target experience, student group/context, adult routine, owner, early indicator and review date. Encourage a practice change people can observe, not a slogan or a new form.

ASK / DO

Ask each team to read its plan aloud in one sentence: "For [group/context], we will [routine], led by [owner], and by [date] we expect [early signal]."

WATCH FOR

Prevent plans that depend entirely on one enthusiastic person, collect sensitive trauma data, or wait a year to learn whether implementation happened.

ROUTE

60: 8 min individual draft. 90: 15 min teams. 120: 25 min with peer critique.

SOURCES

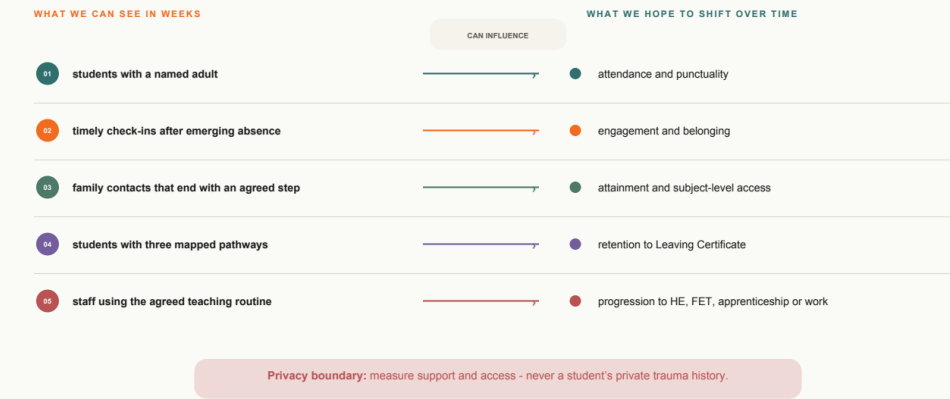
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/>

https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

Track access before outcomes arrive.

MEASURE THE CHANGE YOU CAN SEE EARLY

Track access before outcomes arrive.



Pair early implementation signals with longer-term outcomes. Review for learning, not surveillance.

26

PURPOSE

Give leaders useful implementation indicators and a privacy boundary.

SAY

Lagging outcomes matter, but they move slowly and reflect many factors. Pair them with leading signals that show whether the promised experience is becoming dependable. Data should support learning and coordination, not surveillance or labelling.

ASK / DO

"Which early signal would tell us within four weeks that the routine is actually happening?"

WATCH FOR

Do not collect ACE counts, diagnostic guesses or identifiable narratives for programme measurement.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120; optional in 60 if time is tight.

SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/>
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/services/national-educational-psychological-service-neps/>

Stop. Start. Protect.

A DISCIPLINED COMMITMENT

Stop. Start. Protect.

STOP	START	PROTECT
One routine or phrase that quietly closes a door.	One action the school will test for 90 days.	One strength already changing students' odds.

Write privately first. Share the action, not a confession.

27

PURPOSE

End planning with focus: remove harm, add one practice, and retain what already works.

SAY

Give two quiet minutes. Invite table-level sharing, then ask leaders to collect only actions people are comfortable making public. “Protect” matters because reform that ignores existing strengths can damage trust and capacity.

ASK / DO

Ask for one sentence from each group, prioritising “Start” and “Protect.”

WATCH FOR

Do not turn “Stop” into public blame or a list of individual failings.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120. In 60, use as the closing commitment.

Five moves by Friday.

TAKE IT BACK MONDAY

Five moves by Friday.

01	Name	the students at the edge - and the adult who will notice.
02	Contact	one family with a strength before the concern.
03	Audit	one task for hidden vocabulary, steps or assumed support.
04	Map	A, B and C routes with one student.
05	Schedule	the 90-day review before momentum fades.

Momentum is a design choice.

28

PURPOSE

Convert workshop energy into immediate action without adding a new programme.

SAY

Read the five moves. Ask participants to circle one in the workbook and name when it will happen. The actions deliberately span relationship, family, teaching, progression and implementation.

ASK / DO

"Which one will be visible in your calendar before you leave?"

WATCH FOR

Encourage one completed action, not five vague intentions.

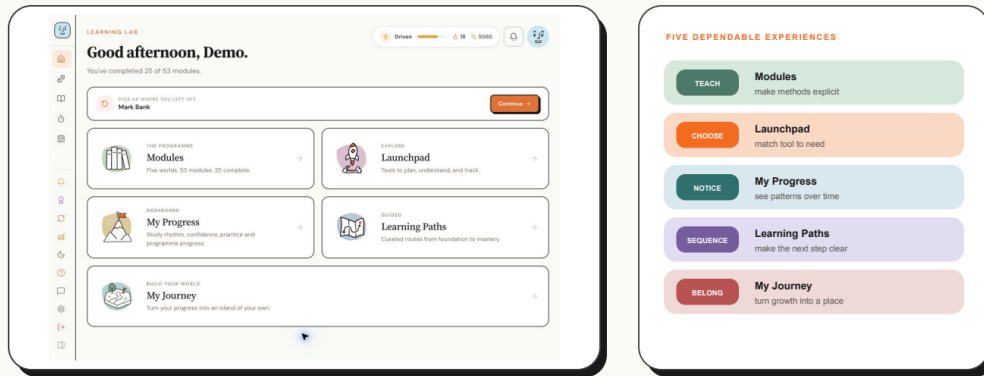
ROUTE

Core in every version.

The app should strengthen a human support system.

FROM WORKSHOP TO STUDENT ROUTINE

The app should strengthen a human support system.



Live Demo Account capture - Home - 16 August 2026. The app supports the routine; relationships, teaching and judgement remain human.

29

PURPOSE

Show the real student home and connect each destination to a dependable school experience.

SAY

The home screen gives one coherent route into teaching, tool choice, progress review, guided sequencing and belonging. Use it to reinforce routines that already involve adults; do not position the product as a substitute for a trusted relationship.

ASK / DO

“Where could one of these experiences strengthen an adult conversation already happening in school?”

WATCH FOR

Do not hand a vulnerable student a menu and call that support. Pair access with orientation and follow-up.

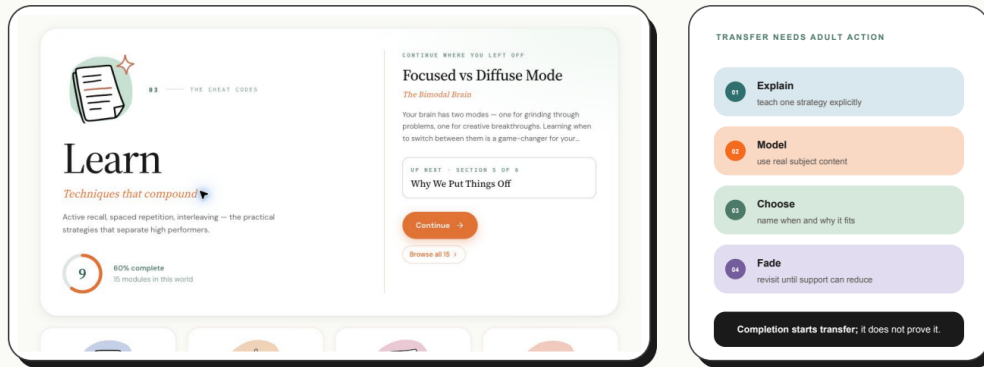
ROUTE

Use near the close in 90/120. In 60, show this overview plus the progress slide.

Teach the method before asking for independence.

FACILITATE GROWTH · TEACH

Teach the method before asking for independence.



Live Demo Account capture · Modules · 16 August 2025. Facilitation sequence grounded in metacognitive modelling.

30

PURPOSE

Position the learning modules as a common language that adults actively teach and revisit.

SAY

The live Modules view shows the five-world programme and a clear continuation point. Teachers make the content usable by modelling it on actual subject work, naming when it applies, checking use and fading support gradually.

ASK / DO

“Which module could become part of an existing tutor, SPHE or subject routine rather than an optional extra?”

WATCH FOR

Do not treat module completion as proof that a strategy transferred into independent study.

ROUTE

90/120. Optional in 60.

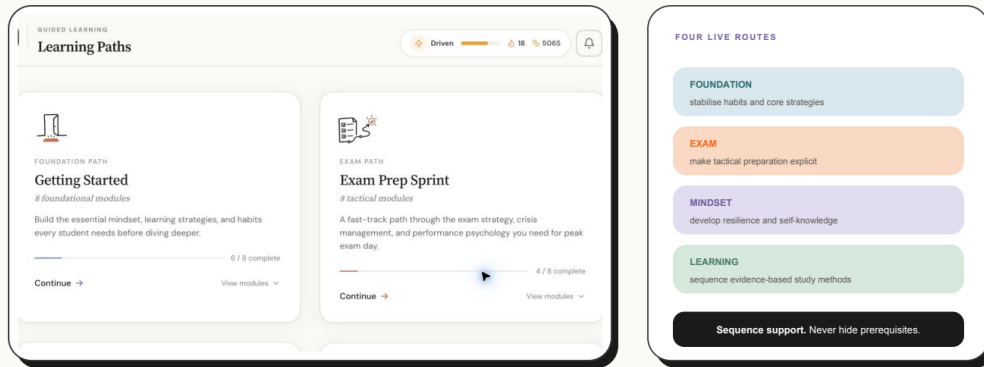
SOURCES

<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>

A pathway makes the next step visible without shrinking ambition.

FACILITATE GROWTH · SEQUENCE

A pathway makes the next step visible without shrinking ambition.



Live Demo Account capture - Learning Paths - 16 August 2025.

31

PURPOSE

Show how curated routes reduce decision load while preserving challenge and future options.

SAY

Learning Paths organise modules into a visible sequence. Adults can use them to make prerequisites explicit, choose a sensible starting point and review progress without making the student navigate the entire programme alone.

ASK / DO

“Where is a student currently expected to infer the sequence for themselves?”

WATCH FOR

A route should remain revisable. Do not turn a suggested path into a ceiling.

ROUTE

90/120. Optional in 60.

SOURCES

<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>

Make the next study session easy to begin.

FACILITATE GROWTH · PRACTICE

Make the next study session easy to begin.



Live Demo Account capture · Mathematics Practice session · 18 August 2020.

32

PURPOSE

Show how an in-subject study session can reduce initiation friction while preserving an evidence-based learning routine.

SAY

The live Mathematics session keeps the subject, purpose, time and an elaboration prompt visible. Agree the product, method, accuracy check and return point before the timer starts.

ASK / DO

“Could a supervised study period begin with this four-part prompt?”

WATCH FOR

Do not reward minutes without examining the task and the evidence produced.

ROUTE

90/120. Optional in 60.

SOURCES

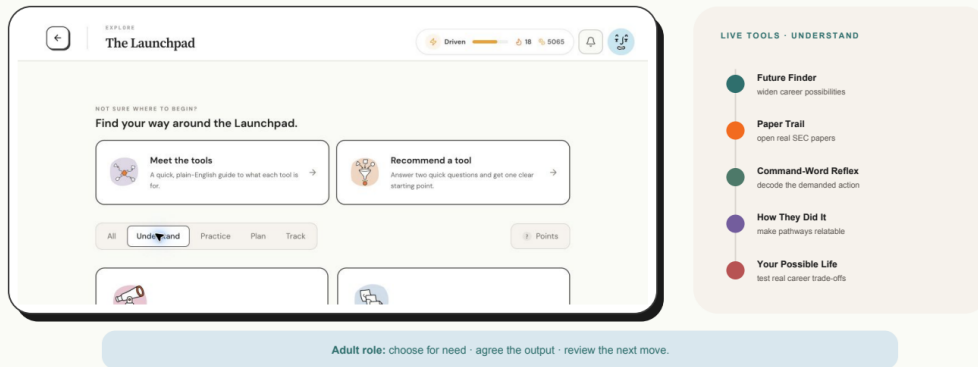
<https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1>

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/how-to-create-study-routines-for-the-leaving-certificate-during-the-covid-19-pandemic/>

Make demanding material and possible futures easier to enter.

LAUNCHPAD · UNDERSTAND

Make demanding material and possible futures easier to enter.



Live Demo Account capture · Launchpad Understand filter · 16 August 2026.

33

PURPOSE

Present the real Launchpad tools as a menu organised by student need.

SAY

The live filtered view keeps the choice understandable. An adult helps the student select a tool, agrees what successful use will produce and reviews whether it changed the next action.

ASK / DO

Which unfamiliar task could we make more legible without making it less ambitious?

WATCH FOR

Avoid prescribing a tool from a label or treating tool use as evidence of learning by itself.

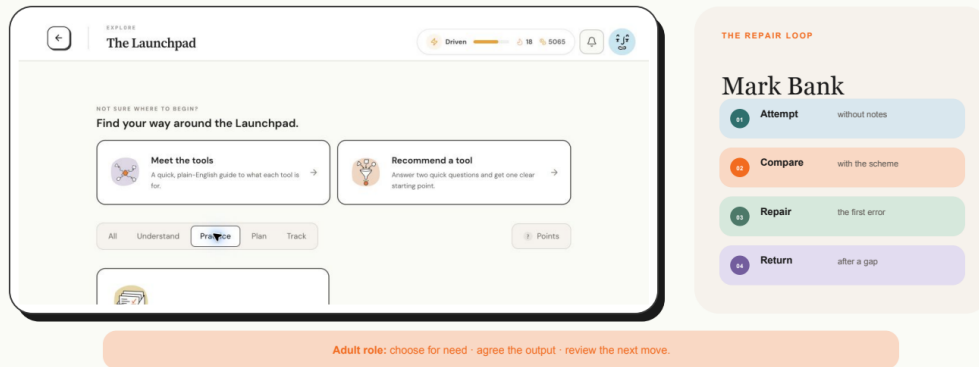
ROUTE

90/120. In 60, show the two Launchpad groups most relevant to the school.

Turn effort into feedback, repair and another attempt.

LAUNCHPAD · PRACTICE

Turn effort into feedback, repair and another attempt.



Live Demo Account capture · Launchpad Practice filter · 18 August 2026.

34

PURPOSE

Present the real Launchpad tools as a menu organised by student need.

SAY

The live filtered view keeps the choice understandable. An adult helps the student select a tool, agrees what successful use will produce and reviews whether it changed the next action.

ASK / DO

Where does practice currently stop before feedback changes the next attempt?

WATCH FOR

Avoid prescribing a tool from a label or treating tool use as evidence of learning by itself.

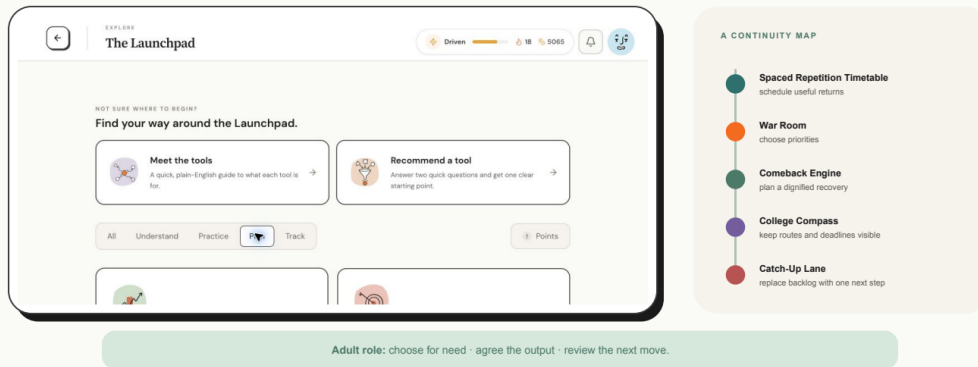
ROUTE

90/120. In 60, show the two Launchpad groups most relevant to the school.

Protect continuity when time, confidence or attendance slips.

LAUNCHPAD • PLAN

Protect continuity when time, confidence or attendance slips.



Live Demo Account capture • Launchpad Plan filter • 16 August 2026.

35

PURPOSE

Present the real Launchpad tools as a menu organised by student need.

SAY

The live filtered view keeps the choice understandable. An adult helps the student select a tool, agrees what successful use will produce and reviews whether it changed the next action.

ASK / DO

Which tool could turn “catch up” into one visible next step?

WATCH FOR

Avoid prescribing a tool from a label or treating tool use as evidence of learning by itself.

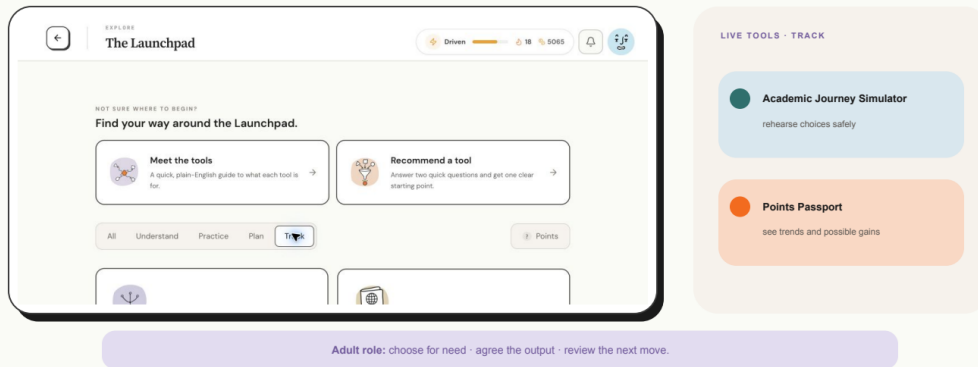
ROUTE

90/120. In 60, show the two Launchpad groups most relevant to the school.

Make choices, routes and progress discussable.

LAUNCHPAD · TRACK

Make choices, routes and progress discussable.



Live Demo Account capture · Launchpad Track filter · 16 August 2026.

36

PURPOSE

Present the real Launchpad tools as a menu organised by student need.

SAY

The live filtered view keeps the choice understandable. An adult helps the student select a tool, agrees what successful use will produce and reviews whether it changed the next action.

ASK / DO

Which student needs a route made visible rather than chosen for them?

WATCH FOR

Avoid prescribing a tool from a label or treating tool use as evidence of learning by itself.

ROUTE

90/120. In 60, show the two Launchpad groups most relevant to the school.

Practice must end with feedback and a next move.

FACILITATE GROWTH · FEEDBACK

Practice must end with feedback and a next move.

The image shows a digital interface with two main components. On the left is a question card titled 'BIOLOGY · HIGHER LEVEL · 2020 · Q7(D)' with a '4a' icon. The question asks to 'Answer the following questions in relation to the scientific method. Give two limitations of the scientific method.' Below the question is a 'THE SCHEME' section with a 'I had them all' indicator and a progress bar '8 of 2'. It lists six options for limitations: 'Accidental discovery', 'application to nature', '(human) bias', 'human error', 'constrained by existing knowledge', and 'constrained by existing technology'. On the right is a vertical sidebar titled 'THE LEARNING LOOP' with four colored buttons: 'Attempt' (blue, 'without notes'), 'Compare' (orange, 'against the scheme'), 'Decide' (green, 'missed - shaky - got it'), and 'Repair' (purple, 'before moving on'). At the bottom of the sidebar is a black button that says 'Repair changes the next attempt.'

Live Demo Account capture · Biology Mark Blank · real SEC question and scheme · 16 August 2026.

37

PURPOSE

Connect exam practice, marking guidance, self-assessment and error repair.

SAY

The live Biology session shows one of five cards, a real question, its SEC-aligned scheme and the Missed it/Shaky/Got it decision. Use that decision to schedule repair and later retrieval.

ASK / DO

“What would make “shaky” a useful next-action category rather than a label?”

WATCH FOR

Self-rating is fallible. Calibrate it with worked examples, teacher feedback and later retrieval.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120; show briefly in 60.

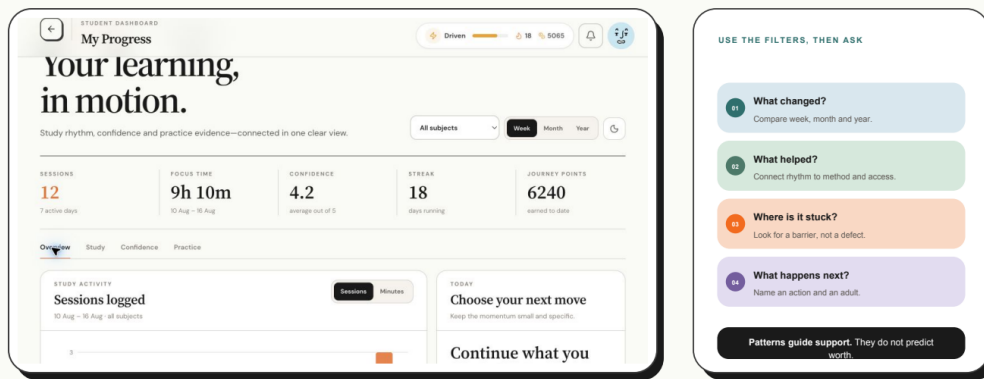
SOURCES

<https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/guidance-reports/feedback>

A dashboard should start a conversation - not issue a verdict.

FACILITATE GROWTH · REVIEW

A dashboard should start a conversation - not issue a verdict.



Live Demo Account capture · My Progress Overview · 16 August 2026. Sessions/minutes and week/month/year filters are live.

38

PURPOSE

Use live product data as a prompt for reflection, recognition and targeted support.

SAY

The live Overview connects study rhythm, focused minutes, confidence, subject allocation, Five Climbs, techniques and mock evidence. Change the timeframe, then ask what changed, what helped and what support comes next.

ASK / DO

"Who reviews this with the student, and how often, so that the data changes a next action?"

WATCH FOR

Avoid rankings, deterministic predictions and surveillance. Sparse data may reflect access barriers as well as motivation or skill.

ROUTE

Core in every version.

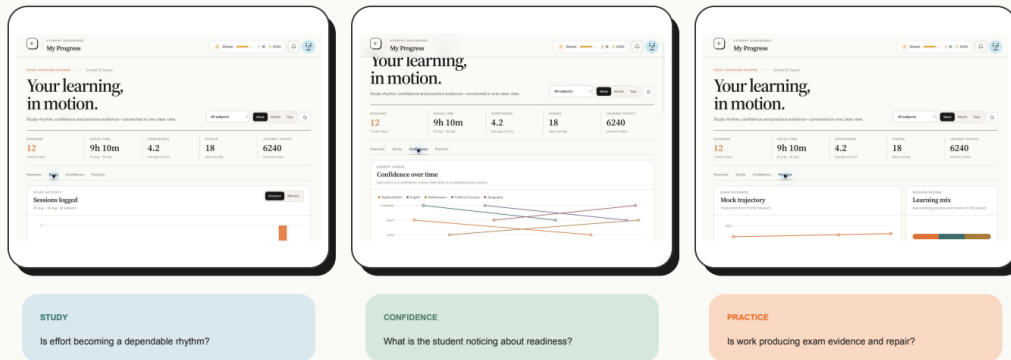
SOURCES

<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/guidance-reports/feedback>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>

Rhythm, confidence and practice stay connected.

MY PROGRESS · THREE LENSES

Rhythm, confidence and practice stay connected.



Live Demo Account captures - Study, Confidence and Practice tabs - 16 August 2026. Five Climbs remains visible in the Confidence view.

39

PURPOSE

Show the current Study, Confidence and Practice views without collapsing progress into one number.

SAY

Study shows consistency and technique use; Confidence shows reflections and the Five Climbs programme landscape; Practice shows mock trajectory, readiness and method use. Review the lenses together so one chart does not become a judgement.

ASK / DO

"Which lens would help this student name a useful next step?"

WATCH FOR

Confidence is a reflection signal, not a measure of ability. Practice evidence also needs context.

ROUTE

Core in 90/120; optional detail in 60.

SOURCES

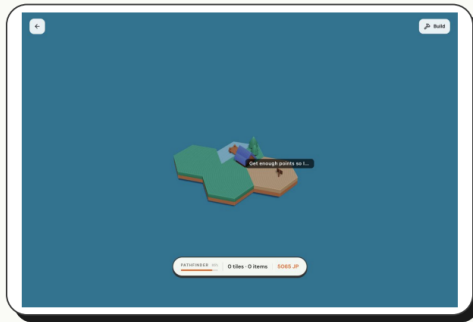
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/guidance-reports/feedback>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>

Let progress become a place the student can shape.

FACILITATE GROWTH · BELONG

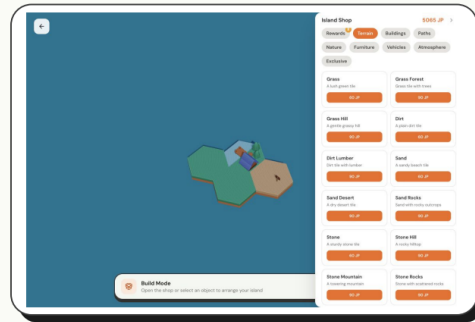
Let progress become a place the student can shape.

JOURNEY MODE



Journey: accumulated effort becomes a place and a story.

BUILD MODE



Build: meaningful choice adds authorship without public ranking.

Live Demo Account captures - Journey and Build modes - 16 August 2026. Compare neither islands nor spending publicly.

40

PURPOSE

Explain how the live Journey and Build modes can support continuity, ownership and belonging when used carefully.

SAY

Journey mode makes accumulated effort visible as a place rather than only a score. Build mode adds meaningful choice over what the student places and changes. Use the space as a reflection prompt: what does this represent, what changed and what does the student want to build next?

ASK / DO

"How could an adult notice the story behind the build rather than praise only the amount completed?"

WATCH FOR

Do not compare islands publicly or make decorative rewards the primary reason to learn.

ROUTE

90/120. Optional in 60.

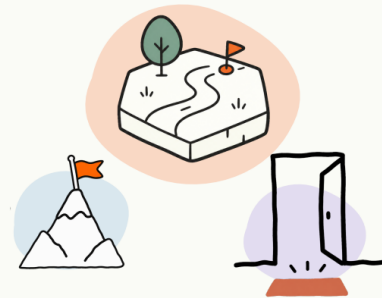
Be the school that keeps the door open.

THE INVITATION

Be the school that keeps the door open.

Not every barrier begins in school.

But school can decide whether a barrier becomes a ceiling.



Return to your story. End with the student, not the programme.

41

PURPOSE

Return to the opening story and close with responsibility, hope and collective agency.

SAY

Return briefly to the student you were and the adult action that changed what was possible. Avoid claiming school can solve poverty or trauma. Land on the distinction: schools cannot control every starting condition, but they can protect access, challenge, belonging and navigation.

ASK / DO

Optional final line to the room: "Whose door will be more open because of what we do next?"

WATCH FOR

Finish cleanly. Do not add a new content section after this slide.

ROUTE

Core in every version.

National statistics and policy sources.

EVIDENCE BASE · IRELAND

National statistics and policy sources.

CSO	SILC Module on Child Deprivation 2024	https://www.cso.ie/en/releasesandpublications/ep/p-silccd/silcmoduleonchilddeprivation2024/keyfindings/
Tusla	Analysis of School Attendance Data 2023/24	https://www.tusla.ie/uploads/content/Analysis_of_School_Attendance_Data_2023-24.pdf
Department of Education	DEIS Strategy to 2035; retention and attendance material	https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/
OECD	PISA 2022 Results - Ireland country note	https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/pisa-2022-results-volume-i-and-ii-country-notes_ed6fbcc5-en/ireland_01173012-en.html
HEA	Socio-economic profiles of students, 2021/22-2023/24	https://hea.ie/statistics/data-for-download-and-visualisations/students/widening-participation-for-equity-of-access/socio-economic-profiles-2021-22-2023-24/student-profile/
ESRI / GUI	Self-concept, expectations and teacher-student relationships	https://www.esri.ie/publications/how-are-childrens-academic-self-concepts-their-parents-expectations-and-their
OECD	Review of Resourcing Schools to Address Educational Disadvantage in Ireland	https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

42

PURPOSE

Make the evidence traceable.

SAY

This slide is not normally presented line by line. Leave it available for questions and circulate the facilitator guide/workbook references.

WATCH FOR

Check figures against the dated source before reusing the deck in a future year.

ROUTE

Appendix/reference.

SOURCES

<https://www.cso.ie/en/releasesandpublications/ep/p-silccd/silcmoduleonchilddeprivation2024/keyfindings/>
https://www.tusla.ie/uploads/content/Analysis_of_School_Attendance_Data_2023-24.pdf
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/deis-strategy-to-2035/>
https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/pisa-2022-results-volume-i-and-ii-country-notes_ed6fbcc5-en/ireland_01173012-en.html
<https://hea.ie/statistics/data-for-download-and-visualisations/students/widening-participation-for-equity-of-access/socio-economic-profiles-2021-22-2023-24/student-profile/>
<https://www.esri.ie/publications/how-are-childrens-academic-self-concepts-their-parents-expectations-and-their>
https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-review-of-resourcing-schools-to-address-educational-disadvantage-in-ireland_3433784c-en.html

Teaching, attendance, trauma and pathways.

EVIDENCE BASE · PRACTICE

Teaching, attendance, trauma and pathways.

NEPS	Service, Continuum of Support and trauma resources	https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/collections/national-educational-psychological-service-neps-resources-and-publications/
EEF	Metacognition and self-regulation; feedback	https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation
IES / WWC	Organizing Instruction and Study to Improve Student Learning	https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1
Department of Education	How to create study routines for the Leaving Certificate	https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/how-to-create-study-routines-for-the-leaving-certificate-during-the-covid-19-pandemic/
EEF	Attendance interventions evidence summary	https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/leadership-and-planning/supporting-attendance/summary-of-evidence
Campbell systematic review	Effects of trauma-informed approaches in schools	https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6355036/
UK Government	Caution on use of ACE screening tools	https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/trauma-informed-practice-learning-from-experience/trauma-informed-practice-learning-from-experience-of-violence-reduction-unit-delivery-2021-to-2023-accessible
DFHERIS	Education pathways in Ireland	https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-further-and-higher-education-research-innovation-and-science/press-releases/ministers-lawless-and-harkin-urge-all-learners-to-explore-the-unprecedented-number-of-education-pathways-now-available/
Access College / SUSI	HEAR and student grant information	https://accesscollege.ie/hear/how-do-i-apply/eligibility-criteria/

43

PURPOSE

Make the practical guidance and its limits traceable.

SAY

Use this slide for questions about evidence quality. Be especially transparent that school-wide trauma-informed evidence is still developing; the workshop prioritises low-risk, role-clear practices aligned with NEPS.

WATCH FOR

HEAR, SUSI, apprenticeship and course details change. Recheck annually.

ROUTE

Appendix/reference.

SOURCES

<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/collections/national-educational-psychological-service-neps-resources-and-publications/>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/teaching-learning-toolkit/metacognition-and-self-regulation>
<https://ies.ed.gov/ncee/wwc/PracticeGuide/1>
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-education/publications/how-to-create-study-routines-for-the-leaving-certificate-during-the-covid-19-pandemic/>
<https://educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/leadership-and-planning/supporting-attendance/summary-of-evidence>
<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6355036/>
<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/trauma-informed-practice-learning-from-experience/trauma-informed-practice-learning-from-experience-of-violence-reduction-unit-delivery-2021-to-2023-accessible>
<https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-further-and-higher-education-research-innovation-and-science/press-releases/ministers-lawless-and-harkin-urge-all-learners-to-explore-the-unprecedented-number-of-education-pathways-now-available/>
<https://accesscollege.ie/hear/how-do-i-apply/eligibility-criteria/>